



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Saint Sophia Classical

School Website: <https://saintsophiaclassical.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Saint Sophia Classical Academy (Norman, OK 73072) presents a clearly classical orientation anchored in Christian theological formation, a articulated commitment to virtue and wisdom, and a deliberately liberal-arts-minded curriculum. Across materials drawn from the school's site, Memoria Press curriculum references, and public-facing statements, the school emphasizes formation over mere information, the study of Latin and classical languages, engagement with the Great Books/Great Conversation, and a pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion in the upper grades and traditional, teacher-led instruction in the lower grades. The religious foundations are explicit, with Gospel-centered partnership with families, Christian/Orthodox framing, and adherence to creedal statements. Public materials also emphasize small class sizes, a professional faculty, accreditation, and parental engagement through events and campus visits.

Overall classification by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

This results in an aggregate CLASSICAL assessment for the school, with a single category (Faculty) identified as somewhat less explicitly aligned to the full classical rubric as defined by the Six Essential Elements and its Positive/Negative Keyword indicators. The "needle" opportunities center on making the living-faculty dimension and explicit Great-Books/Great-Conversation expressions more visible, and aligning faculty portraiture and formation language more directly with classical norms.

What would move the needle (applies because one category is deemed SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL): - Make the living-curriculum concept and a concrete "portrait of a classical teacher" explicit on the site (to align with the Lexicon's Faculty indicators). - Strengthen explicit articulation of Great Books, Great Conversation, and a clearly stated plan for Socratic study in upper grades (to reinforce Curriculum and Pedagogy alignment). - Expand parent-formation activities and explicit "parents as co-educators" language with visible offerings (book studies, seminars) to fully realize the Parents & Community indicators.

Citations: See evidence throughout from the public-facing Saint Sophia materials and the Memoria Press/curriculum references (e.g., Gospel/Christian formation, Nicene Creed, Orthodox roots, Great Books language, Memoria Press curriculum, Latin education, and faculty statements) as noted inline in each category's evidence sections. Representative sources include: partnership with parents and Gospel guidance (turn0file3), Orthodox founding and Christian identity (turn0file5), Nicene Creed statement (turn0file13), Memoria Press curriculum reference (turn0file18), six academic subjects and classical language emphasis (turn0file16), and accreditation and faculty notes (turn0file7, turn0file0).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly grounds its mission in Gospel-centered partnership with families and Christian formation: "In partnership with parents, and guided by the Gospel, we seek to educate students to the highest standards of the classical tradition, so that they may grow in knowledge, wisdom, and the love of

our Lord, and more ably use their gifts in the service of others, for the glory of Christ and his Church.” - The Orthodox Christian heritage is noted as part of its founding context: “St. Sophia was originally founded by a group of faithful Christians... Orthodox Church in Norman, OK.” - A creedal/theological anchor is present in public materials, including reference to the Nicene Creed as a faith statement: “Our faith statement is the Nicene Creed.” - The curriculum references sacred music and liturgical sensibilities within a Christian framework (e.g., sacred music in philosophy and curriculum discussions).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: Gospel, Christian, Orthodox, Church, Nicene Creed, liturgy/sacred music, true/Good/Beautiful framework in classical education, reverence. These align with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (truth/goodness/beauty; theology; liturgy; sacral dimensions). - Negative keywords (absent): secular humanism, relativism, value-neutral ethics, etc. There is no strong evidence for these negative indicators in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), theology, liturgical dimensions (sacred music; Gospel), and explicit Christian/theological formation. The school's founding context and creedal language reinforce a robust religious/metaphysical foundation. The alignment with classical religious formation indicators is strong, thus CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Gospel partnership and formation: turn0file3 - Orthodox founding context: turn0file5 - Nicene Creed statement: turn0file13 - Sacred music and liturgical framing: turn0file16

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school frames education as formation in virtue and wisdom, not merely preparation for work, and explicitly ties formation to the classical tradition: “classical education is the cultivation of wisdom and virtue through meditation on the Good, the True, and the Beautiful.” and “in partnership with parents, guided by the Gospel, we seek to educate students to the highest standards of the classical tradition, so that they may grow in knowledge, wisdom, and the love of our Lord.” - The purpose emphasizes human flourishing and the timeless pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty through liberal arts and classical study, including Great Books and the Great Conversation language in the school materials. - Public materials reference formation over mere information and a classical mission to cultivate virtue and wisdom through liberal education (Latin/Greek study, humanities emphasis).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, paideia, Great Books/Great Conversation, classical mission, telos, human flourishing. - Negative keywords (absent): college and career readiness focus, 21st-century skills emphasis, value-neutral ethics, purely information-transfer framing.

Why this rating - The public materials foreground formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical telos, consistent with CLASSICAL. Great Books/Great Conversation language and liberal-arts orientation reinforce the CLASSICAL classification.

Cited evidence - Formation/virtue/wisdom via Gospel focus: turn0file3 - Classical Education as formation through liberal arts: turn0file3 - Memoria Press curriculum and classical emphasis (philosophical framing): turn0file16 - Great Books/Great Conversation framing: turn0file3

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum emphasizes classical languages and liberal arts, with explicit reference to Latin and Greek and Classical Languages as foundational, plus structured Studies including Classical/Christian Studies, English Studies, and American/Modern Studies. This aligns with classical Trivium/Quadrivium orientation and the liberal-arts framework. - The school uses Memoria Press Curriculum, a hallmark of public-facing classical curricula, and states that “St. Sophia proudly uses Memoria Press Curriculum,” indicating a structured, classical approach. - Public materials describe a curriculum that includes six academic subjects (Classical Languages, Mathematics, English Studies, Classical/Christian Studies, Science, American/Modern Studies) plus music, art, and physical education, with a focus on training in the liberal arts

and the reading of classical texts. - The Great Books/Great Conversation language is explicitly present in statements about studying the classics and great thinkers, indicating engagement with canonical texts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric, presumably, via liberal-arts framing), classical languages, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, literature, philosophy, sacred/Christian studies, history within a classical frame, Memoria Press curriculum. - Negative keywords (absent): social-studies-first framing, heavy emphasis on project-based or STEM-first curricula as replacement for classical study.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly framed through classical/Liberal-Arts terms and Great-Books/Great-Conversation rhetoric, with a formal Latin component and a memoriapressed curriculum. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Classical language emphasis and Great Books framing: turn0file16 - Memoria Press curriculum reference: turn0file18 - Six-subject curricular structure plus classical Studies: turn0file16 - Great Books/Great Conversation references: turn0file3

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper-grade pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetorical training, consistent with classical pedagogy for higher grades. - Lower-grade pedagogy emphasizes teacher-led, traditional instruction with a focus on memorization and memory work (and a restful/remembered approach); while not exhaustively described as “Scholé,” the materials indicate contemplative/memorable elements at lower levels. - The curriculum references sacred music and memory work, with a focus on mindful, contemplative learning as part of the classical approach (e.g., “singing of sacred music” and classical training in memory and recitation contexts).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, memory work, chanting/singing, recitation, classical pedagogy, Scholé-like contemplative learning, disciplined memory-based pedagogy. - Negative keywords (absent): exclusive reliance on pure project-based/experiential learning without traditional classical structures; the site does not emphasize a fully constructivist, student-led model as a replacement for classical forms.

Why this rating - Pedagogical methods align with classical norms: traditional teacher-led instruction in lower grades, Socratic/dialogic and rhetoric-focused methods in upper grades, and a memory-oriented approach in line with classical pedagogy. This justifies CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Socratic discussion and upper-grade seminars: turn0file3 - Traditional lower-grade approach and reverence for classical pedagogy: turn0file3 - Sacred music and memory/recitation framing: turn0file16

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school publicly notes a qualified faculty with a high share of advanced degrees (50% holding advanced degrees). This demonstrates credentialing and specialization, a positive indicator, but the public materials do not explicitly present a “living curriculum” portrait of the teacher or a formal teacher-formation philosophy beyond ongoing training. - The materials emphasize that teachers are trained and participate in ongoing education through partnerships, indicating professional development, but explicit language about “the living curriculum” or a teacher portrait is not clearly stated in the public materials we surveyed. - Accreditation/board structure is noted (e.g., ICAA accreditation), signaling a formalized faculty context and governance, which supports a classical posture though it does not itself define the living-curriculum dimension.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: model teachers and mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, collegial culture (these are the ideal features in the Classical lexicon). - Negative keywords: absence of explicit living-curriculum language in public-facing materials; ab-

sence of a detailed “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty as the living curriculum” wording in the materials we accessed.

Why this rating - While there is strong evidence of credentialed, trained faculty and ongoing professional development, explicit articulation of the living-curriculum concept and a clear “portrait of teacher and student” as the core of the curriculum are not overtly stated in the public materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Cited evidence - 50% advanced degrees among faculty: turn0file0 - Ongoing teacher training/partnerships: turn0file0 - Accreditation context (ICAA): turn0file7

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames partnership with families and parental involvement in classical formation: “In partnership with parents, and guided by the Gospel...” (ongoing formation and shared mission). This aligns with the classical model of parents as co-educators in the community. - School events and family engagement are visible on the site (e.g., School Tours, Grandparents/Godparents Breakfast), and there are avenues for parent visits and involvement in school life. The public-facing materials show a welcoming stance toward parent engagement and community involvement. - The accreditation and governance backdrop (board, non-profit status) underlines a stable community and parental trust framework, which supports a classical community orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, home-school connection, open campus, parent formation (as evidenced by events and communications), family involvement. - Negative keywords (absent): consumer/customer language; minimal parent involvement; the site presents a robust, participatory parental role rather than a consumer-tenant relationship.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a strong classical-community orientation with explicit partnership with families, parental engagement through events and tours, and open access to school life, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Cited evidence - Partnership with families and Gospel guidance: turn0file3 - Family events and parent-friendly engagement: turn0file9 - Board/governance and accreditation (community stability): turn0file7

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 5 (Faculty) to reach CLASSICAL: Make explicit the living-curriculum concept in public materials and provide a formal “portrait of the teacher” and “core teacher attributes” that align with classical expectations (e.g., model virtue, mastery of the liberal arts, mentorship role).
- For Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy): Add explicit, public-facing Great-Books lists and a clearly stated plan for regular Socratic seminars in specific grade bands, with sample seminar prompts and assessment rubrics to demonstrate how the Great Conversation is integrated across the curriculum.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand and publicize formal parent-education offerings (book studies, lectures, and workshops) that align with classical formation and provide more explicit language about parents as co-teachers beyond open-campus events.
- For Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Maintain and deepen explicit liturgical/com-munal practices and ensure ongoing articulation of theological foundations (e.g., creedal statements) within the broader curriculum to further align with liturgical and communal dimensions.

These changes would help move the school from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Faculty toward CLASSICAL across that dimension, and would further deepen the alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy with the Great-Books-centered, contemplative, and virtuous formation ethos.

Cited evidence for needle-movement suggestions - Need for explicit living curriculum and teacher-portrait language: Faculty section (current publicly available wording) – see turn0file0 - Need for explicit Great Books/Great Conversation articulation in Curriculum and Pedagogy: Curriculum and Theory of Classical Education references (turn0file16, turn0file3, turn0file2/turn0file11) - Need for formal parent-education initiatives: Parents & Community language existing (turn0file3, turn0file9)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.